

7

6

5

4

3

2

1

L

LONG WAY DOWN

JASON
REYNOLDS

FINAL ASSESSMENT

SAME BUILDING.
DIFFERENT FLOORS.
BIGGER QUESTIONS.

Name: _____ Block: _____ Date: _____

PART I — MULTIPLE CHOICE

Choose the best answer for each question.

- 1 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 2 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 3 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 4 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 5 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 6 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 7 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 8 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 9 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 10 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

- 11 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 12 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 13 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 14 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 15 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 16 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 17 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 18 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 19 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
- 20 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

PART II — SHORT RESPONSE

Write your response in the space below.

LONG WAY DOWN

BY JASON REYNOLDS

FINAL ASSESSMENT STUDY GUIDE



LITERARY ELEMENTS TO KNOW

Literary Element

What It Means

Long Way Down Example



Characterization

How an author reveals a character's personality, beliefs, or changes.

Will begins confident that he must follow the Rules, but each visitor causes him to question his thinking.



Inference

A conclusion based on clues from the text.

Will does not directly say he is abandoning the Rules, but his questions and fear show growing uncertainty.



Theme

A larger message or idea developed throughout a text.

Questioning what we have been taught can help us make our own choices.



Symbolism

When something represents a larger idea.

Smoke can represent the confusion and uncertainty surrounding Will's choices.



Structure

How an author organizes a text to create meaning.

Each elevator floor introduces someone whose story adds another challenge to Will's beliefs.



Repetition

Repeating words or ideas for emphasis or effect.

Repetition builds tension and emphasizes Will's uncertainty (ex. "Right?").



Irony

When reality is different from what is expected or believed.

The Rules are supposed to "make things right," yet Will learns they have caused more pain and consequences.



Suspense

Creating uncertainty about what will happen or what is true.

Frick's "Who?" creates doubt about Will's belief that Riggs killed Shawn.



Visual Structure

The arrangement of words on the page adds meaning.

Reynolds shapes repeated "Right?" into a question mark as Will questions his plan.



Ambiguous Ending

An ending that intentionally leaves something unanswered.

"You coming?" leaves Will's final choice unknown and makes readers consider what he will do.

THE ELEVATOR FLOOR-BY-FLOOR REVIEW

7

BUCK

First visitor. His appearance begins challenging Will's confidence.

6

DANI

Asks "What if you miss?" and introduces doubt about Will's plan.

5

UNCLE MARK

Makes Will imagine his plan like a movie and think about what happens afterward. "It's never the end."

4

POP

Reveals that he was certain he had the right person—but was wrong. This challenges Will's belief that certainty makes an action right.

3

FRICK

His story shows how one choice leads to another. His "Who?" raises serious doubt about Will's belief about Riggs.

2

SHAWN

Will admits he is scared and unsure. Shawn cries even though Rule #1 is "No Crying."

L

LOBBY

"You coming?" Will must make his own choice. Reynolds does not tell us what he decides.

THE RULES

1

No Crying

2

No Snitching

3

Revenge

WILL'S JOURNEY

CERTAIN

→ CHALLENGED

→ QUESTIONING

→ ?

IMPORTANT CONNECTIONS

- **Pop:** Being certain doesn't mean you're right.
- **Random Thought No. 4:** Will may be following others blindly.
- **Frick:** Choices can create more choices and consequences.
- **Shawn crying:** Even Shawn does not completely fit the Rules.
- **"Right?":** Will is questioning what he once accepted.
- **"You coming?":** The choice ultimately belongs to Will.